



Universal Patient Care

Assessment

Pediatric Pearls:

- Use pediatric dosing of medications or electrical therapy for a pediatric patient < 37 kg and as defined by HandTevy.
- Utilize appropriately sized equipment for every patient

Signs & Symptoms:

- Location
- Onset
- Precipitating Event(s)
- Quality
- Radiation
- Severity
- Time/Duration
- Aggravating/Alleviating
- Associated Symptoms
- Prior history of same/similar

Differential:

- Vascular
- Infectious/Inflammatory
- Trauma/Toxins
- Autoimmune
- Metabolic
- Idiopathic
- Neoplastic
- Congenital
- Behavioral

All patients, should receive an assessment appropriate to their age and condition.

- 1) Scene size up, appropriate PPE, scene safety, environmental hazards assessment, need for additional resources, bystander safety, patient-caregiver interaction, clues related to the patient condition (e.g., environment, paraphernalia, clothing)
- 2) Initial assessment includes a general impression as well as a rapid assessment of airway, breathing, circulation, mental status (AVPU & GCS), and disability (e.g., motor/neuro deficits and pupil response)

Pediatric assessment triangle

Appearance: Tone, interactiveness, consolability, gaze, cry

Work of breathing: head bobbing, grunting, breath sounds, accessory muscle usage, nasal flaring & body positioning, respirations

Circulation to skin: pallor, mottling, cyanosis

- 3) Complete critical interventions that preserve airway, breathing, or circulation first, then those that save limbs, and last those that provide comfort.
- 4) Manage system resources – request any additional/specialized units or downgrade/cancel units when appropriate
- 5) Perform a focused history and physical based on the patient's chief complaint, trying to protect patient privacy and modesty. Complete secondary exam to include baseline set of vital signs as directed by patient complaint and appropriate COG. Visually inspect the area of complaint (e.g., remove patient's shoe when complaining of blisters, remove hat when a complaint is headache, etc.)
- 6) Consider the patient's mental status and mental health. Help reduce barriers to care. Consider integrated services and other community resources.
- 7) Transport the patient when on-scene interventions have been completed. Remember that lights and sirens are interventions with risks—utilize them appropriately.
- 8) Continuously re-assess the patient throughout transport. Assess before and after any intervention and the need for any additional intervention(s). Assess for evolving complaints/conditions.
- 9) Document all findings and information associated with the assessment, patient history (medical hx, medications, allergies, etc.) performed procedures, and any medications on the ePCR.

Consult Online Medical Control As Needed